

ATS Resume Checklist + Bullet Formula

Use this before you apply. Catch formatting and wording mistakes that get resumes filtered out.

1. ATS formatting checklist

- One column layout (no tables, text boxes, or multi-column designs)
- Standard section headers: Summary, Experience, Education, Skills
- Common fonts only (Calibri, Arial, Garamond, Georgia)
- No headers/footers for contact info - put it in the body
- File named clearly: FirstName_LastName_Resume.pdf
- Also keep an editable Word (.docx) version
- Avoid icons, charts, skill bars, and headshots
- Dates and job titles on the same visual line as the employer when possible

2. Keyword match (5-minute scan)

- Paste the job description into a doc and highlight required skills
- Mirror exact phrases when they are true for you
- Put the top 6-8 skills in a Skills section near the top
- Use the job title (or closest true title) in your summary
- Do not keyword-stuff - every skill should show up in a bullet or role

3. Bullet formula

Action verb + what you did + how/tools + result (number if possible)

Weak: Responsible for customer emails and tickets.

Strong: Resolved 40+ support tickets weekly in Zendesk, cutting average first-response time by 25%.

Weak: Helped with social media and content.

Strong: Wrote and scheduled 12 LinkedIn posts/month that grew engagement 35% over one quarter.

Weak: Worked on team projects and reporting.

Strong: Built weekly Excel dashboards for a 6-person ops team, reducing manual status updates by about 3 hours/week.

4. Before you hit submit

- Every bullet starts with a strong verb (Led, Built, Improved, Launched)
- At least half your bullets include a metric, scope, or timeframe
- Summary is 2-3 lines max and aimed at one target role
- No typos; phone/email/LinkedIn are current
- You tailored at least the summary + top bullets to this job

Want this done for you?

Get a full ATS-friendly rewrite with code RESUME50 for 50% off.

<https://www.builtbyashley.com/resume>